

Topic: Major social institutions

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Marriage

- “Marriage is more or less durable connection between male and female lasting beyond the mere act of propagation till after the birth of offspring” (Edward Westermarck, History of Human Marriage, 1921).
- “ Marriage is a relatively permanent bond between permissible mates” (Lowie, Social Organization, 1950).
- Malinowsky says “ Marriage is a contract for the production and maintenance of children.”

Types of marriage

1. Monogamy
2. Polygyny
3. Polyandry
4. Group marriage

Others-

- i. Levirate (Marriage with brother-in-law)
- ii. Sororate (Marriage with dead wife's sister)
- iii. Exogamy (Out group)
- iv. Endogamy (In group).

Family

- ❖ “Family is a group defined by a sex relationship sufficiently precise and enduring to provide for the procreation and upbringing of children” (MacIver and Page, Society, 1986: 238).
- ❖ “Family is more or less durable association of husband and wife with or without children or of a man or woman alone, with children” (Nimkoff, Marriage and the Family, 1947: 6).

Types of family

1. On the basis of degree of power-

- i. Patriarchal
- ii. Matriarchal.

2. On the basis of post marital place of residence-

- i. Patrilocal
- ii. Matrilocal
- iii. Neolocal.

3. On the basis of descent and property inheritance-

- i. Patrilineal
- ii. Matrilineal.

4. On the basis of size of family-

- i. Nuclear or single (one wife, one husband and unmarried children)
- ii. Extended family (wife, husband, children and grandchildren)
- iii. Joint family (wife, husband, children and grandchildren+ husband's other brothers, their family, relatives)

5. On the basis of number of spouses-

- i. Monogamous family
- ii. Polygynous family
- iii. Polyandrous family
- iv. Family based on group marriage.

6. On the basis of principles of the selection of spouse-

- i. Exogamous
- ii. Endogamous

Types of exogamous –

- a. Hypergamy (higher caste bridegroom+ lower caste bride)
- b. Hypogamy (lower caste bridegroom+ higher caste bride)

Kinship

- ❖ Robin Fox (Kinship and Marriage) says, “ Kinship is simply the relations between ‘kin’ i. e., persons related by real, putative or fictive consanguinity.”

- ❖ Robertson (Sociology) says, “ Kinship is a network of people related by common ancestry, adoption, or marriage.”

Types of kinship

1. Ties of biological ancestry or consanguinity
2. Ties of marriage or affinity
3. Fictional ties
4. Customary ties
5. Ties of adoption (Possho son or daughter).

Religion

- ❖ Emile Durkheim says, “ Religion as a unified system of beliefs and practices relative to sacred things, that is to say things set apart and forbidden.”
- ❖ Tylor (Primitive Culture) says that “ Religion is the belief in spiritual being.”

Characteristics of religion

Schaefer (Sociology, 1983) and David Popenoe (Sociology, 1986) said about the following characteristics of religion-

1. Sacred
2. Beliefs
3. Symbol
4. Ritual
5. Experience and
6. Organisation.

Education

- ❖ Education is the process of facilitating learning, or the acquisition of knowledge, skills, values, morals, beliefs, habits, and personal development. Education originated as transmission of cultural heritage from one generation to the next.
- ❖ Aristotle says, “ Education is the creation of sound mind in a sound body.”
- ❖ Emile Durkheim (1956) says that “ Education is the influence exercised by adult generation on those who are not yet ready for social life. It’s object is to arouse and to develop in children those physical, intellectual and moral states which are required of them both by their society as a whole and by the milieu for which they are especially destined.”
- ❖ “ Education is a philosophical as well as a sociological concept, denoting ideologies, curricula, and pedagogical techniques in the inculcation and management of knowledge and the social reproduction of personalities and cultures.” (Oxford Dictionary of Sociology, 2009: 205).

Types of Education

1. Formal
2. Informal
3. Non-formal

State

- ❖ “The state is a political unit legally permitted to use force within a specified territory” (Shephard, Sociology, 1981:489).
- ❖ “The state is the institution that successfully claims a monopoly of the legitimate use of force within a given territory” (Robertson, sociology, 1980: 569).
- ❖ “The state is an institution that holds the supreme power in a society that claims a monopoly over the legitimate use of force” (Popenoe, Sociology, 1986: 584).

Elements of state

1. Population
2. Specific area
3. Government
4. Sovereignty.